

Grill Station Orientation

Owner and Purpose

- Document owner: Priya Nair (Sous Chef, Grill)
- Purpose: Station map, heat zones, ticket flow and mise en place for new grill cooks. How to set up, cook consistently, communicate with Expo, and close down safely.

Station Map and Heat Zones

Left third: sear (650°F+). Middle: cook. Right: hold/rest.

- Visual map (left to right):
 - Left third = Sear zone (high flame, dry grates). For initial marks and crust.
 - Middle = Cook zone (steady heat for bringing items to temp).
 - Right = Hold/rest zone (lowest heat or coolest corner). For carryover and staging just before plate-up.
- Manage zones:
 - Preheat at least 20 minutes before service; confirm left third reads 650°F+.
 - Keep left third clean and lightly oiled; carbonized grates = bitter flavor.
 - Keep right side clear of direct flames; use this zone to rest proteins and avoid overcooking.

Mise en Place Checklist

Proteins portioned and labelled · chimichurri (fresh) · finishing salt · herb oil · fry baskets · clean towels in sanitizer (red bucket, 200 ppm quat).

Add these supports so service runs clean:

- Tools: 2 long tongs (label for raw/cooked), 1 fish spatula, bench scraper, grill brush, probe thermometer, timer, squeeze bottles (herb oil), hotel pans with wire racks, parchment for resting board.
- Backups: extra clean towels, fresh sanitizer test strips, extra probe batteries, foil.
- Labels: date/time initials on all open items; raw vs cooked containers kept apart and below/above per Food Code.
- Fire control: salt for flare-ups (never water).

Ticket Flow and Communication

Expo calls, grill calls back the count, fires on “Order, fire!”. Temps are read with a probe — never by touch.

- Call-backs:
 - On “Order!” repeat item and count: “Heard, two strip, one salmon.”
 - Fire only when you hear “Order, fire!” from Expo.
- Mid-cook updates: call “two minutes out strip” or “need 90 seconds salmon” so Expo can pace sides.
- Probe use:
 - Insert from the side into the thermal center; avoid bone and grill marks.
 - Wipe probe with sani towel between checks.

Cooking Standards and Doneness Targets

- Season at the board, not over the grill. Pat dry for better sear.
- First contact on the left third for crust; move to middle to finish; rest on the right.
- Resting: most cuts rest 2–4 minutes on rack or board before plate.
- Use the table below as house targets; confirm all with probe.

Item	Target Internal Temp	Notes
Steak rare	125°F	Hard sear, short middle time; rest 2 min.
Steak med-rare	130–135°F	Standard for most steaks unless guest requests otherwise.
Steak medium	140–145°F	Keep middle zone steady; rest 3 min.
Steak med-well	150–155°F	Longer middle time; avoid left zone after first sear.
Steak well	160°F+	Use right zone to prevent charring; extend rest.
Burger	155°F	Press with spatula only for contact; never squeeze juices out.
Chicken	165°F	Finish in middle; rest 3–5 min to carryover and set juices.
Salmon	125–130°F	Pull slightly under; carryover on right zone achieves final.

Pork chop	145°F	3 min rest minimum.
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Setup Procedure (Pre-Service)

1. Wash hands; set red bucket at 200 ppm quat; verify with test strip.
2. Light grill; preheat all zones, then tune: left third high (650°F+), middle medium, right low.
3. Brush and oil grates: brush, wipe with lightly oiled towel, repeat until clean and glossy.
4. Set boards: raw board left, cooked/plating board right. Separate tongs labeled for raw/cooked.
5. Stage mise: proteins portioned and labelled, chimichurri (fresh), finishing salt, herb oil, fry baskets, clean towels in sanitizer (red bucket, 200 ppm quat).
6. Thermometer check: ice water slurry should read 32°F; if off, calibrate or swap.
7. Fire test: sear a trim piece to confirm crust in 30–45 seconds on left third.

Service Flow (During)

8. On call, repeat count; fire only on “Order, fire!”.
9. Sear on left third; set cross marks by rotating 45° after initial color if requested.
10. Move to middle to reach target temp; check with probe; call time updates to Expo.
11. Rest on right zone; glaze/finish: herb oil and finishing salt as directed on spec.
12. Plate hot; hand to Expo; reset grates with a quick brush swipe.
13. Keep station wiped; switch towels if soiled; maintain sanitizer at 200 ppm.

Food Safety and Allergen Control

- Cold hold 41°F or below; hot hold 135°F or above.
- Reheat cooked items to 165°F before hot holding.
- Raw below ready-to-eat; cooked tools never touch raw product.
- Allergens: clean grate area (brush, wipe, oil), fresh towel, fresh tongs, and new pan for any allergen ticket. Verbally confirm “allergen grill clear” to Expo.

Troubleshooting and What To Do If

- Flare-ups: move item to middle or right; kill flame briefly; salt the fire if needed; brush grate, re-oil.
- Grill too cool: confirm gas/airflow, clear debris, increase preheat. If left third isn’t 650°F+, alert Priya Nair immediately.
- Uneven cooking: rotate item 180°, shift to a hotter/cooler lane; use a rack on right to prevent scorching.
- Behind on fires: tell Expo “grill is three minutes heavy”; prioritize shortest-cook proteins first.

- Running low on proteins: call pars to Prep; 86 only via Chef/Expo confirmation.
- Probe reading jumps: replace battery or grab backup; never guess doneness by touch.
- Chimichurri looks oxidized: pull and replace with fresh; do not serve dull or brown sauce.

Close-Down and Cleaning

14. Land last tickets; move grates to high to carbonize residue 5–10 minutes.
15. Brush thoroughly; cool slightly; wipe with lightly oiled towel to season grates.
16. Power down gas; close valves. Empty drip tray into approved waste.
17. Discard any time/temperature abused items; label and chill safe leftovers promptly.
18. Buckets: dump, rinse, make fresh sanitizer (200 ppm quat); wipe all contact surfaces.
19. Tools: wash-rinse-sanitize and air-dry; store raw and cooked tool sets separately.
20. Restock for next shift: towels, test strips, fuel checks, backup probes. Report any maintenance needs to Priya Nair.